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THURSDAY JANUARY 30, 2025
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MOHAMMAD TOURS ARAB HEALTH

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, took a tour of the Arab Health exhibition at Dubai World Trade Centre yesterday. During the visit he said the UAE supports every initiative that enhances human health and improves the services provided. **SEE ALSO P3**

30 killed in Kumbh Mela stampede

Elderly people, women
crushed as pilgrims
rush for ritual bathing

PRAYAGRAJ

A pre-dawn stampede at the world's largest religious gathering killed at least 30 people in India yesterday, with many more injured after a surging crowd spilled out of a police cordon and trampled bystanders.

As pilgrims rushed to participate in a sacred day of

ritual bathing, people sleeping and sitting on the ground near the rivers told AFP they were trampled by huge swells of devotees coming towards them in the darkness.

"The entire crowd fell on top of me, trampling me as it moved forward," pilgrim Renu Devi, 48, told AFP.

"When the crowd surged, elderly people and women were crushed, and no one came forward to help."

Rescue teams carrying victims from the accident site weaved through piles of

clothes, shoes and other discarded belongings. Police were seen carrying stretchers bearing the bodies of victims draped with thick blankets.

"Thirty devotees have unfortunately died," senior police officer Vaibhav Krishna told reporters during an evening news conference at the festival. "Ninety injured were taken to the hospital." Krishna's briefing came nearly 18 hours after the stampede and was the first official death toll given by authorities. —AFP

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NATION

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Israel delays delivery of aid to Gaza

11 MORE HOSTAGES, INCLUDING FIVE
THAIS, TO BE RELEASED THIS WEEK

JERUSALEM

Hamas officials accused Israel yesterday of delaying aid deliveries to Gaza and jeopardising a truce and hostage release deal, an allegation Israel dismissed as "fake news."

Two senior Hamas officials accused Israel of slowing down aid deliveries, with one citing items key to Gaza's recovery such as fuel, tents, heavy machinery and other equipment.

"According to the agreement, these materials were supposed to enter during the first week of the ceasefire," one official said.

"We warn that continued delays and failure to address these points will affect the natural progression of the agreement, including the prisoner exchange."

Charges dismissed

Israel hit back at the accusation, with a spokesman for COGAT, the Israeli defence ministry body that oversees civil affairs in the Palestinian territories, calling it "totally fake news".

Between Sunday and 1100

GMT yesterday, "3,000 trucks entered Gaza", the spokesman said. "The agreement says it should be 4,200 in seven days," he added.

Meanwhile, Israel said yesterday that 11 more hostages held in Gaza, including five Thais, would be freed over two days this week as part of a fragile Gaza ceasefire.

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office said it had received a list from Hamas of eight hostages to be freed today including the Thais, and another three, all men, to be released on Saturday.

"Israel received the list of hostages who are supposed to be released from Hamas captivity tomorrow," the Israeli premier's office said.

—AFP

SEE ALSO P10

Netanyahu's office
said it had received
a list from Hamas of
eight hostages to be
freed today including
the Thais, and another
three, all men, to be
released on Saturday.



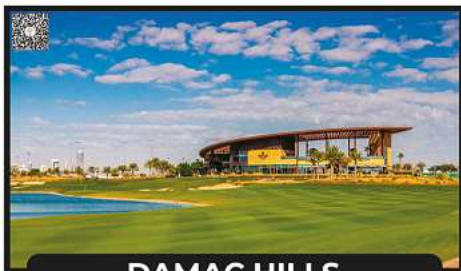
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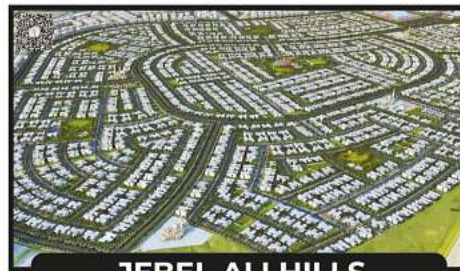
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